

The Dhāraṇī Called 'The Noble Goddess of Rays of Light'

Āryamāricī-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 564 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་མ་འདོ་བའི་ཅན་ཞེས་བ་བྱའུ་གི་བུ་སྒྲུབ།

Toh 564 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Āryamāricī-nāma-dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as the Phakma Özerchen zhé jawa'i Zung, meaning "The Dhāraṇī of the Noble Goddess of Rays of Light." It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur and centers on Māricī, a goddess associated with the rays of light that precede the sun and moon, who is described as utterly invincible, invisible, and immune to all harm and obstruction. The text is set in Śrāvastī, where the Buddha addresses a large assembly of monks and bodhisattvas, presenting this dhāraṇī as a means by which practitioners may invoke Māricī's protective and wish-fulfilling powers. As a dhāraṇī scripture, it belongs to the broader class of canonical texts that transmit sacred formulas believed to confer blessings, protection, and spiritual benefit upon those who recite or uphold them.

In the language of India: Āryamāricī-nāma-dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The dhāraṇī called "The Noble Goddess of Rays of Light."

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling in Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, together with a great Saṅgha of thirteen hundred and fifty monks, and with many great bodhisattvas.

Then the Blessed One declared to the monks: "Monks, there is a goddess named Māricī, the Goddess of Rays of Light. She travels before the sun and before the moon. She cannot be seen, cannot be seized, cannot be bound, cannot be obstructed, cannot be contested, cannot be confused, cannot be cut down by punishment, cannot have her head split open, cannot be repelled, cannot be burned. She does not fall under the power of enemies.

"Monks, whoever knows the name of that Goddess of Rays of Light — that person likewise cannot be seen, cannot be seized, cannot be bound, cannot be obstructed, cannot be contested, cannot be confused, cannot be cut down by punishment, cannot have their head split open, cannot be repelled, cannot be burned, and will not fall under the power of enemies.

"Therefore, by knowing the name of the Goddess of Rays of Light, may I too become unable to be seen, unable to be seized, unable to be bound, unable to be obstructed, unable to be contested, unable to be confused, unable to be cut down by punishment, unable to have my head split open, unable to be repelled, unable to be burned, and may I not fall under the power of enemies.

"The words of the secret mantra are these:

Tadyathā: Oṃ patākramasi, parākramasi, udayamasi, nairamasi, arkamasi, markamasi, urmamasi, vanamasi, gulmamasi, cīvaramasi, mahācīvaramasi, antardhvaṃnamasi svāhā.

Oṃ — Goddess of Rays of Light, protect me on my path. Protect me from wrong paths. Protect me from the fear of violent people. Protect me from the fear of kings. Protect me from the fear of elephants. Protect me from the fear of thieves. Protect me from the fear of nāgas. Protect me from the fear of lions. Protect me from the fear of tigers. Protect me from the fear of fire. Protect me from the fear of water. Protect me from the fear of snakes. Protect me from the fear of poison. Protect me from adversaries and from all enemies. In all disturbances and freedoms from disturbance, in all defeats and freedoms from defeat, guard me from lions, guard me from tigers, guard me from nāgas, guard me from snakes — svāhā.

Guard me from all fears, from harm, from contagious disease, and from all disturbances — guard me, guard me!

Namo ratnatrayāya. Tadyathā: Oṃ ālo, tālo kālo, sacchalo samapamūrdhiṭi, rakṣa rakṣa māṃ. Guard me and all sentient beings from all harm, fear, and illness — svāhā.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

Now shall the heart-mantra of the Goddess of Rays of Light be recited:

Tadyathā: Oṃ bṛṭṭali, badāli, barāli, bārāhamukhi, sarvaduṣṭā, praduṣṭānāṃ, cakṣurmukhaṃ bandha bandha, bandha, mukhaṃ, jambhaya, stambhaya, mohaya svāhā. Oṃ mārīcyai svāhā. Oṃ barāli, badāli, bṛṭṭali, bārāhamukhi, sarvaduṣṭānāṃ, praduṣṭānāṃ, cakṣurmukhaṃ bandha bandha svāhā."

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, those monks and those bodhisattvas and all the assembled retinue, together with the gods, humans, asuras, and...

